

VICARIOUS CLOTHING

Website Design & Development Blueprint

Complete UX, ecommerce, admin, technical architecture and phased implementation plan

PURPOSE

A working design specification for ONSoftware to use while building Vicarious Clothing's independent ecommerce platform. It is intended to guide visual design, customer journeys, inventory behaviour, administration, backend structure, security and future expansion.

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Version 1.0 - August 2026

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1. Product Vision

Vicarious Clothing should feel like a real independent fashion retailer from day one, not a Vinted profile with a checkout attached. Pre-owned stock should shape the inventory model, product information and brand story, but the customer experience should remain modern, fast and fashion-first.

CORE OBJECTIVE

Sell directly, establish an independent brand, reduce dependence on marketplaces and create infrastructure that can grow into multi-channel and eventually physical retail.

The guiding engineering principle is: build the site for the order volume Henry has now, but structure the data and workflows so it can support much larger volume later without a rewrite.

2. Site Map

```

VICARIOUS CLOTHING
├── HOME
├── SHOP
│   ├── New In
│   ├── All Clothing
│   ├── Tops / Hoodies / Knitwear / Jackets / Trousers / Jeans
│   ├── Footwear / Accessories / Vintage / Sale
├── COLLECTIONS
│   ├── Latest Drop / Vicarious Picks / Under £25
├── BRANDS
├── ABOUT
├── SELL TO US
├── JOURNAL [Phase 2]
├── ACCOUNT
│   ├── Profile / Orders / Addresses / Wishlist / Preferences
├── BAG
├── CHECKOUT
├── HELP
│   ├── Contact / Delivery / Returns / FAQs / Size Guide
│   └── Condition Guide / Terms / Privacy / Cookies
  
```

The important addition is Sell To Us. Once Henry begins buying stock directly from the public, the site should eventually support the acquisition side of the business as well as the selling side.

3. Design System

Visual language

- Editorial rather than template-heavy.
- Large product photography and campaign imagery.
- Strong typography with generous whitespace.
- Minimal interface chrome and restrained use of accent colour.
- Clothing should supply most of the visual colour; the interface should frame it.

Layout

Element	Recommendation
Desktop max width	Approx. 1400-1500 px
Grid	12-column responsive system
Mobile	Designed mobile-first; 2-column product grid where appropriate
Spacing	Generous vertical rhythm; avoid dense dashboard-like retail pages
Photography	Consistent aspect ratio, high-quality responsive images

Typography

Use one strong grotesque/geometric sans-serif for headings and navigation, and a highly readable sans-serif such as Inter for body copy and interface labels. A monospace face can be used selectively for SKU, condition, measurements and catalogue metadata.

VICARIOUS
CARHARTT DETROIT JACKET
VC-000381 / VERY GOOD / SIZE M
£64.00

4. Global Navigation

Desktop header

Free UK delivery over £XX					Sell to us →			
VICARIOUS	NEW	SHOP	BRANDS	ABOUT	🔍	♡	🛒	BAG

Use VICARIOUS prominently in navigation while the full trading identity remains Vicarious Clothing. The header should become compact and sticky once the customer scrolls.

Footer

Column	Links
Shop	New In, All Clothing, Sale, Brands
Help	Delivery, Returns, Contact, Condition Guide
Company	About, Sell To Us, Journal, social links
Legal	Terms, Privacy, Cookies and required trader information

5. Homepage

Hero

The opening hero should be campaign-led, not explanatory. Use a full-width image or short video with a very short message and one dominant action.

NEW LIVES.
SAME CLOTHES.

Curated clothing, ready to go again.
[SHOP NEW IN →]

Homepage sequence

1. Hero campaign.
2. New In product row.
3. Editorial collection feature such as Vicarious Picks.
4. Shop by category tiles.
5. Short brand story.
6. Recently sold / missed these section.
7. Newsletter capture.

8. Footer.

Recently sold

Showing a restrained number of recently sold pieces can communicate scarcity, movement and authenticity. Sold items should be visually marked and link customers to similar available products rather than creating dead ends.

Newsletter

GET THERE FIRST.
New pieces don't tend to stay around.
[EMAIL ADDRESS_____] [JOIN →]

Marketing consent must be voluntary and separate from order-related processing.

6. Shop & Collection Pages

Desktop

SHOP					138 ITEMS
FILTER					SORT: NEWEST
CATEGORY	SIZE	BRAND	CONDITION	PRICE	
[PRODUCT]	[PRODUCT]	[PRODUCT]	[PRODUCT]	[PRODUCT]	
[PRODUCT]	[PRODUCT]	[PRODUCT]	[PRODUCT]	[PRODUCT]	

Mobile

SHOP	
138 ITEMS	
[FILTER]	[SORT]
[PRODUCT]	[PRODUCT]
[PRODUCT]	[PRODUCT]

Filters

- Category
- Brand
- Size
- Condition
- Colour
- Price
- Gender/department only if the catalogue genuinely uses it

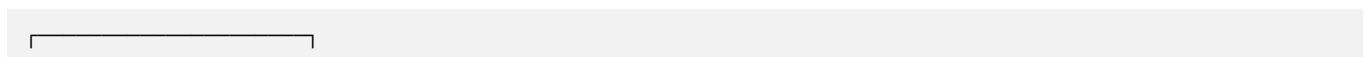
Brand names, categories and condition values should come from controlled database records or enums, not arbitrary text entry, so Nike, NIKE and nike do not become three different filters.

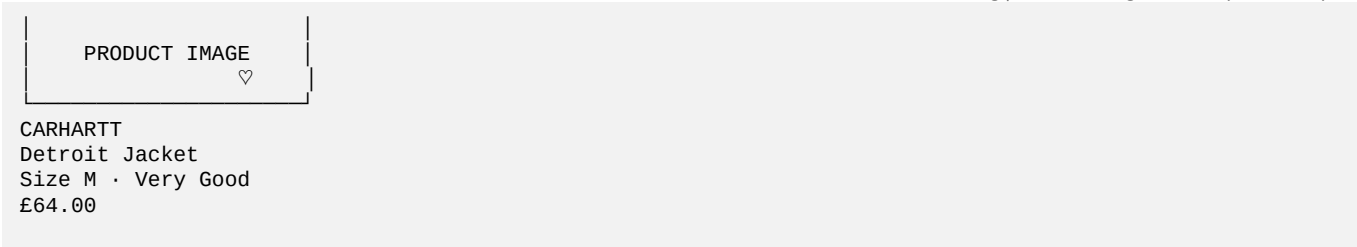
Sort

- Newest - recommended default
- Price low to high
- Price high to low
- Recently reduced - optional later
- Most popular - optional later

7. Product Cards

Cards should be deliberately quiet so the product photograph remains dominant.

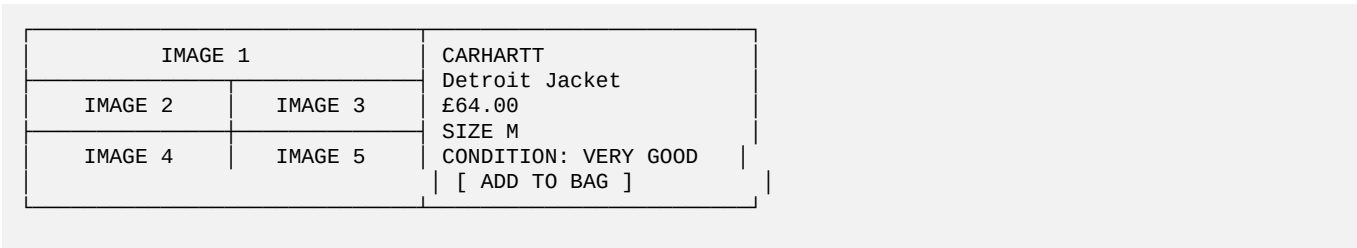




On desktop, hover can transition from the primary image to a secondary angle. Avoid covering every card with large quick-add controls because most stock is one-off and customers benefit from seeing condition and measurements before buying.

8. Product Detail Page

Desktop structure



On desktop, purchasing information can remain sticky while the customer scrolls through images. On mobile, show image carousel first, then title, price, size, condition and a strong add-to-bag control.

Information hierarchy

- Description.
- Condition.
- Measurements.
- Product details: brand, size, colour, material and SKU.
- Delivery & Returns accordion.

Images

Support zoom, swipe, fullscreen, thumbnail navigation and high-resolution responsive images. Every known material defect should be photographed.

9. Condition & Measurements

Condition scale

Grade	Meaning
New with Tags	Unused with original tags attached
New without Tags	Unused but no original tags
Excellent	Minimal or no obvious signs of previous wear
Very Good	Light signs of previous wear; no significant defects unless specifically disclosed
Good	Noticeable signs of wear; all material defects disclosed
Fair	Significant visible wear but still considered saleable

The grade is a summary, not a replacement for item-specific disclosure.

Measurements

Measurement fields should be category-aware. A jacket may need pit-to-pit, length and sleeve; trousers may need waist, rise and inseam. Avoid asking Henry for irrelevant measurements.

10. Search & Brands

Search

WHAT ARE YOU LOOKING FOR?
[Search brands, products, categories...]

TRENDING
Carhartt Nike Jackets Vintage

Search should index title, brand, category, description, SKU and tags.

Brands directory

Once the catalogue is large enough, provide an alphabetical brands page and clean brand URLs such as /brands/carhartt. This improves browsing and creates useful landing pages for search engines.

11. Bag & Checkout

Bag

Use a slide-out bag on desktop and a dedicated /bag route for full access. Show product thumbnail, title, size, condition, price, subtotal and a clear checkout button.

Checkout

Keep the sequence simple: Contact -> Delivery -> Payment -> Review -> Confirmation. Guest checkout should be supported; account creation should never be a prerequisite for purchase.

PAYMENT DESIGN

Use an established payment processor. Vicarious should not unnecessarily store or process raw payment-card details itself.

Confirmation

IT'S YOURS.

Order VC-1048
We'll let you know when it's on the way.
[VIEW ORDER]

12. Inventory Reservation

Most stock is unique. The system therefore needs to prevent two customers from completing checkout for the same physical item.

State	Meaning
AVAILABLE	Can be purchased
RESERVED	Temporarily held for an active checkout/payment attempt
SOLD	Purchase completed

The exact reservation trigger and timeout should be designed around the payment provider. Failed or expired payment should release the item; successful payment should atomically convert it to sold.

IMPORTANT

Inventory changes must be authoritative on the backend. Frontend availability checks alone are not sufficient protection against race conditions.

13. Customer Accounts

Accounts should be optional and useful rather than compulsory.

- Profile
- Orders
- Addresses
- Wishlist
- Marketing preferences
- Security

HELLO, HENRY

ORDERS	2
WISHLIST	8

RECENT ORDERS

VC-1048	DISPATCHED	£64
VC-0992	DELIVERED	£32

14. Wishlist

A wishlist fits fashion retail well. Logged-out customers can use local storage and optionally synchronise after account creation. If a unique item sells, the wishlist should clearly mark it unavailable and offer similar active products rather than pretending it may return.

15. Sell To Us

This should become the acquisition side of the Vicarious platform.

YOUR WARDROBE. OUR NEXT DROP.

Name / Email
 Brand / Item type / Size / Condition
 Upload photographs
 Anything we should know?
 [SUBMIT]

Lead statuses

NEW -> REVIEWING -> OFFER_SENT -> ACCEPTED -> DECLINED -> RECEIVED -> INSPECTED -> PAID

Later, accepted leads can connect directly to the stock-purchase agreement, seller privacy workflow and inventory intake process.

16. Admin Dashboard

DASHBOARD

TODAY	
Orders	4
Revenue	£186
Awaiting dispatch	3
New enquiries	2

INVENTORY	
Available	183
Preparing	21
Aged 60+ days	28

The admin area is more important than flashy customer-facing extras because it determines whether Henry can actually operate the business efficiently.

17. Inventory Admin

SKU	Product	Cost	Price	Status	Location
VC-381	Carhartt Jacket	£18	£64	Listed	A-04
VC-382	Nike Hoodie	£9	£28	Preparing	B-12

Actions

- Add
- Edit
- Duplicate
- Mark sold
- Archive
- Discount
- Print label
- View history

All one-off products should have a unique Vicarious stock identifier.

18. Product Creation Workflow

Avoid one giant form. Split the workflow into clear sections.

Section	Fields
Identity	Brand, product name, category, auto-generated SKU
Product	Size, colour, material, condition
Measurements	Dynamic fields based on category
Acquisition	Source, purchase date, purchase price
Selling	List price, internal floor price, sales channels
Images	Drag/drop and ordering
Storage	Rack/bin/location
Description	Customer-facing copy and defect disclosure

Support Save Draft and Publish so incomplete stock records do not have to go live.

19. Product Economics

PURCHASE COST	£18.00
SALE PRICE	£64.00
EST. PAYMENT FEE	£1.50
PACKAGING	£0.60

OTHER COSTS	£0.00
EST. PROFIT	£43.90
EST. MARGIN	68.6%

The admin interface should calculate expected and actual item economics so Henry does not have to run separate manual calculations for every piece.

20. Orders, Returns & Refunds

Order states

PAID -> PICKING -> READY TO DISPATCH -> DISPATCHED -> DELIVERED, with branches for RETURN REQUESTED, RETURNED, REFUNDED and CANCELLED.

Order view

VC-1048
Henry Smith
16 Aug 2026

Carhartt Detroit Jacket
VC-000381
£64

Royal Mail Tracked 48
Tracking: XXXXXXXX
[MARK DISPATCHED]

Returns and refunds should link back to the original order and item so revenue, inventory, customer history and analytics remain accurate.

21. Discounts

Support percentage, fixed-value, free-delivery and collection-specific discounts with minimum baskets, expiry dates and usage limits. Avoid training customers to expect permanent discount codes.

22. Marketplace Management

Initially, multi-channel management can be a manual status layer.

Channel	Example status
Website	LISTED
Vinted	LISTED
Depop	NOT LISTED
eBay	NOT LISTED

If an item sells elsewhere, master inventory should immediately become SOLD and the website should make it unavailable. Automated delisting can be considered later only where platform rules and APIs permit it.

23. Data Model

users / profiles / addresses
products / product_images / brands / categories
product_measurements / product_conditions
inventory_items / inventory_locations / inventory_history
orders / order_items / payments / shipments

```

returns / refunds
wishlists / wishlist_items
discounts
purchase_leads / sellers / stock_purchases / stock_purchase_items
marketing_consent
audit_logs

```

Product vs inventory item

Keep the catalogue concept separate from the physical unit. A product describes what is being sold; an inventory item represents the thing Henry actually owns, its cost, condition, location and availability. This allows the same architecture later to support multiple identical new products.

24. Authentication & Roles

Customer auth

Email/password is sufficient initially, with Google or Apple sign-in optional later.

Admin auth

Require stronger security, including 2FA. Roles should be enforced server-side.

Role	Purpose
CUSTOMER	Normal shopper
STAFF	Operational tasks
MANAGER	Broader commercial/admin actions
ADMIN	Technical and configuration access
OWNER	Highest business-level authority

25. Audit Logs

Record important administrative actions with actor, action, before/after values and timestamp.

```

Oliver changed VC-381 price
£64 → £52
17 Aug 2026 14:32

Henry refunded order VC-1048
£64
17 Aug 2026 16:12

```

This becomes critical once more than one person can edit products, prices, orders or refunds.

26. Email Architecture

Address	Use
henry@vicariousclothing.co.uk	Owner/business correspondence
hello@vicariousclothing.co.uk	General enquiries
orders@vicariousclothing.co.uk	Order-related contact
support@vicariousclothing.co.uk	Returns and support

notifications@vicariousclothing.co.uk	Transactional website email

Transactional email should be sent by an appropriate service rather than by a normal mailbox. Templates should include welcome/verification, order confirmed, dispatched, refund issued, password reset, sell-to-us enquiry and offer communications.

27. Legal & Consent UX

Legal information belongs both in the footer and at the point where it matters.

- Terms, Privacy, Cookies, Returns, Delivery and Contact in the footer.
- Checkout acknowledgement of terms and privacy information.
- Marketing consent as a separate optional checkbox.
- Cookie controls that provide Accept, Reject Optional and Manage choices where non-essential tracking is used.

WE USE COOKIES
 We use necessary technologies to make the store work.
 With permission, we also use analytics.
 [ACCEPT ALL] [REJECT OPTIONAL] [MANAGE]

28. SEO & Sold Product Behaviour

URL structure

```
/shop
/shop/jackets
/brands/carhartt
/product/carhartt-detroit-jacket-vc-381
```

Use meaningful routes, canonical URLs, page titles, descriptions, Open Graph metadata, image alt text and structured product data where appropriate.

Sold products

Do not immediately delete sold product URLs. A sold page can say 'THIS ONE'S GONE' and show similar active products. This preserves useful links and reduces dead-end 404s.

29. Performance & Accessibility

Performance

- Responsive image sizing
- WebP/AVIF where suitable
- Lazy loading
- CDN delivery
- Compression
- Minimal unnecessary JavaScript
- Caching
- Skeleton/loading states

Do not serve raw multi-megabyte phone images directly to every mobile visitor.

Accessibility

- Keyboard navigation
- Visible focus states
- Semantic headings
- Form labels
- Good contrast
- Alt text
- Accessible validation errors

- Adequate touch targets
- Reduced-motion support

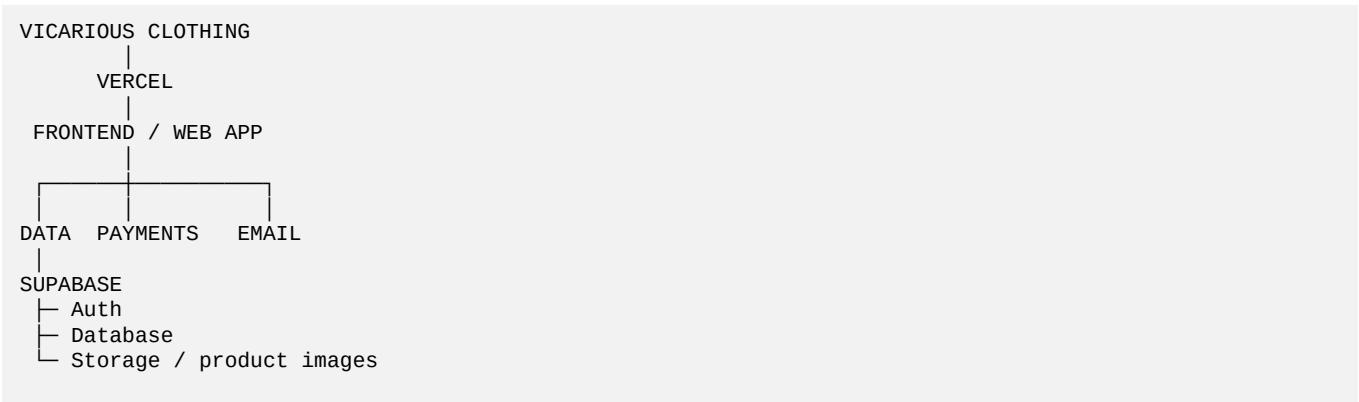
30. Error States

Situation	Suggested copy
404	WRONG TURN. Nothing's hanging here.
Just sold	SOMEONE GOT THERE FIRST. This piece has just sold.
Empty bag	NOTHING YET. Find something.
No search results	Nothing matched that. Try another search or browse everything.

Error states are opportunities for brand personality, but they must still clearly explain what happened and offer a next action.

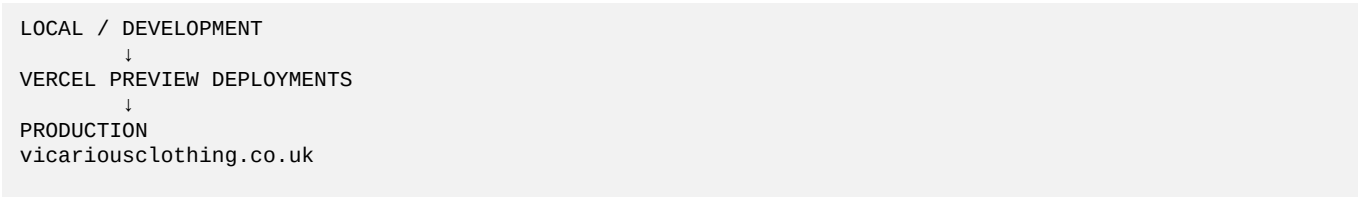
31. Technical Architecture

Given ONSoftware's existing React/Vercel/Supabase experience, a plausible starting architecture is:



The commerce architecture should be decided before implementing checkout, particularly payment state, refunds, inventory reservation, tax treatment and order lifecycle.

32. Environments & Deployment



Production should use separate live payment credentials and, ideally, separate production data from development/test environments. Payment providers should remain in test mode until launch.

33. Backups & Security

Back up

- Inventory
- Orders
- Customer/account data as appropriate
- Stock acquisition records
- Financial records
- Product images
- Legal document versions

Security baseline

- Password manager
- 2FA for privileged users
- Restricted admin access
- Server-side authorisation
- Secure secrets/environment variables
- Software dependency updates
- Logging and monitoring
- Backup/recovery procedure

34. Analytics

THIS MONTH	
Revenue	£2,841
Net profit	£1,184
Orders	71
Items sold	76
Average order	£40.01
Website conversion	2.8%
Return rate	3.1%
Average days to sell	18

Track website vs marketplace revenue as a strategic metric. Over time, Vicarious should aim to increase the proportion of sales it controls directly without sacrificing total profitability.

35. Development Phases

Phase	Build
1. Brand presence	Home, Shop, Product, About, Contact, Legal, Basic Admin
2. Commerce	Bag, Checkout, Payments, Orders, Inventory reservation, Transactional email, Delivery, Returns
3. Retention	Accounts, Wishlist, Email marketing, Discounts, Better search
4. Operations	Advanced inventory, Profit tracking, Purchase records, Sell To Us, Seller workflow, Analytics
5. Multi-channel	Vinted/eBay/Depop status and allowed integrations, shared stock state
6. Physical retail	EPOS, barcodes, receipt printing, click & collect, shared online/store inventory

BUILD DISCIPLINE

Do not build Phase 5 because it is interesting while Phase 2 is unreliable. Every phase should be commercially usable before the next layer becomes a priority.

36. Final Visual Direction

Vicarious should feel like a fashion brand first. Avoid making the visual identity overtly 'eco' through predictable green palettes, recycling symbols and sustainability clichés.

The intended impression is:

CUSTOMER REACTION

"That's a cool clothing store." Followed by: "Oh, most of this is pre-owned."

Use strong photography, large typography, a neutral interface foundation and one distinctive brand accent. The resale proposition should add depth to the brand rather than make the site look like a digital charity shop.

A possible hero direction:

VICARIOUS

LIVE ANOTHER LIFE.

[SHOP NEW IN →]

The long-term goal is for the website backend to become the operating system for Vicarious Clothing: ecommerce, inventory, sourcing, customer service, analytics and eventually physical retail.